

685–668 BCE

SPARTA EMERGES AS THE DOMINANT POWER IN GREECE

Sparta regarded strength and discipline as ideals, and produced an army of fearless fighting men, conspicuous in the battlefield in their distinctive battle dress and crested helmets. As a result, in the 7th century BCE it emerged as the foremost military power in Greece, valuable as an ally, and dangerous as an enemy.

▷ Spartan warrior, bronze



660 BCE

LEGENDARY FIRST EMPEROR OF JAPAN

According to tradition, Jimmu, a descendant of Amaterasu the sun goddess, became the first Emperor of Japan after conquering the whole country. There is little historical evidence of his existence, and the legend appears to be a conflation of mythology and real events. Nevertheless, the supposed date of his accession, 11 February, is still celebrated in Japan as National Foundation Day.



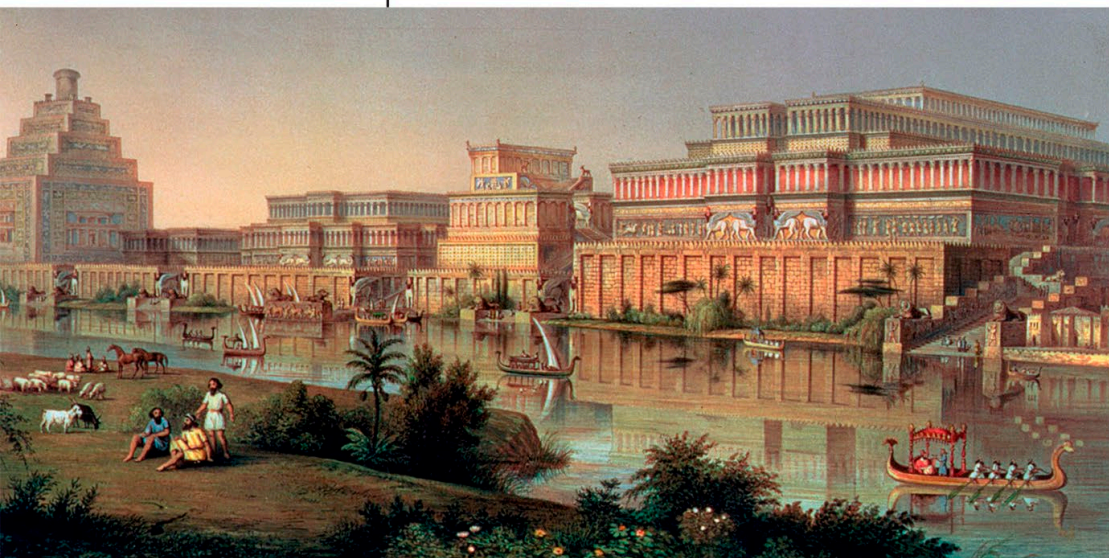
700 BCE

689 BCE The city of Babylon is

destroyed by Assyrian emperor Sennacherib

671 BCE Egyptian capital Memphis

is captured by Assyrian king Esarhaddon; it is regained by the Egyptians eight years later



c. 700 BCE

EXPANSION OF NINEVEH

Sennacherib came to the throne of the Neo-Assyrian Empire in 705 BCE. As well as continuing the expansion of the empire, he set about moving the capital to the city of Nineveh. This involved an extensive programme of renovation in the old city, centred around a “Palace without a rival”, making it one of the largest and most important cities in the world at that time.

◁ Sennacherib’s “Palace without a Rival”